The composition model · Frame · Cell · Tile

Slides as Form

A slide is not content with chrome bolted on. It is a Frame that divides the canvas into Cells, and each Cell holds a Tile. Every deck composes this way, on every render path, with nothing to switch on.

Section 01

The model

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Context · One Model

Form is how a slide is composed, not a setting you turn on.

There is no `form:` key and no per-slide token. Every slide carries the model, so the masthead band, the meta and status bay, and the progress rail are simply where slides put those things. The question an author answers is never *whether* Form — only which Frame a component brings with it.

Three nouns, and only two kinds of object.

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Frame — a slicer

Carves a box into sub-boxes. The root Frame carves the whole slide.

Cell — a typed slot

An empty, sized, positioned box. The seam between a slicer and what fills it.

Tile — a filler

Leaf content sized to fill exactly one Cell. Frame-blind, so it travels.

Medium — the renderer

`2d` today. The Frame manifest is medium-independent by construction, so a second medium would be a renderer — never a deck setting. None is scheduled.

Section 02

Sovereign Frames

Contrast · Nine and One

A bookend is not Form switched off. It is a Frame with one Cell.

The chrome-hosting `standard` Frame declares nine Cells — masthead, lede, bay, stage, footer, footer-left, rail, pagination and overlay. Every sovereign Frame declares exactly one, the stage. They carry no band and no rail because their Frame has nowhere to put one, which is a fact about the component, not a flag on the deck.

Evidence · One Composition, Three Paths

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The same model resolves identically wherever a deck renders.

The owned engine, the emulator and the browser runtime share one eligibility helper — so a deck composes the same in an export, a preview and a raw Marp tool.

3	1	0
RENDER PATHS	SHARED HELPER	WAYS TO OPT OUT

WIP

Takeaway · The Bay

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The bay docks the meta and status Tiles.

KEY INSIGHT

Key insight: the `meta:` line and a status chip (this slide is `wip`) ride the bay because the Frame reserves a Cell for them — not because the deck asked for one.

Section 03

Orientation

Close · Orientation

The footer orients the audience, on every slide that has one.

The running footer, the page number and the section rail sit in Cells the chrome-hosting Frame reserves. A sovereign slide shows none of them, and the deck still reads as one deck — the bookends are the pauses, and the rail picks up again on the other side.

Form, always.